

Plate 2.21 Leftover Food

The ultimate use of leftovers depends on where the meal was eaten, preferences of the diner, and the prevailing social culture. People often save home cooking leftovers to eat later. This is facilitated by the private environment and convenience of airtight containers and refrigeration. People may eat some leftover food cold from the refrigerator, or reheated it in a microwave or conventional oven, or mix it with additional ingredients and recooked to make a new dish.

Types of Leftover Foods

There are three classes into which leftover food can be divided in catering establishments.

a. Raw foods



Plate 2.22 Leftover Vegetables

Raw foods are perishable and semi perishable that are supplied to the kitchens for preparation. The fresh forms of foods are also considered as leftovers when the quantities are not enough for serving single portion.

b. Partly cooked food

These include marinated meats, paneer, unserved salads in refrigeration, juices, boiled eggs, fermented mixtures as dough and batter. These can be creatively used as barbecued meats with vegetables added on before cooking. Small amount of juices can be used as toppings for fruit pies, custards, shakes, puddings and cakes.



Plate 2.23 Leftover Paneer

c. Cooked Foods

When cooked food remains in large quantities it usually gets pilfered or wasted though mishandling and spoilage unless it is reused in some way and presented to customers again soon after.



Plate 2.23 Leftover Vegetable Pulao

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